Aspire Demo Pte Ltd - Invoice Approval Workflow

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1. Purpose

This procedure defines how supplier invoices are received, matched, approved and paid by the Accounts Payable (AP) team. It exists to prevent duplicate and fraudulent payments and to ensure that every payment is authorised at a level appropriate to its value. It applies to all vendors across the Singapore, Vietnam and Indonesia entities.

2. Invoice Intake

• All invoices must be sent to the AP mailbox (ap-inbox at the company domain) or uploaded to the vendor portal; invoices sent to individual staff must be forwarded within 1 working day.

• AP logs each invoice in the ERP within 2 working days and assigns a unique Invoice Reference (format INV-YYYY-nnnnnn).

• Invoices lacking a valid PO number, tax registration number or bank details are returned to the vendor within 2 working days.

• Standard payment terms are 30 days from invoice date unless the contract states otherwise.

3. Three-Way Match

Before approval, AP performs a three-way match between (a) the Purchase Order, (b) the Goods Receipt Note or service acceptance confirmation from the budget owner, and (c) the vendor invoice. Tolerances: price variance up to 2 percent or SGD 100 (whichever is lower), quantity variance 0 percent for goods. Items outside tolerance are placed on hold and sent back to the requester, who has 5 working days to resolve. Invoices without a PO are allowed only for utilities, regulatory fees and legal disbursements, and are flagged as Non-PO spend in the monthly report.

4. Approval Tiers

Invoice value (SGD)	Required approvers
Below 5,000	Budget owner's line manager
5,000 to 50,000	Head of Department and Finance (Finance Controller or delegate)
Above 50,000	CFO, in addition to Head of Department and Finance
Any value, related party or new vendor first payment	Finance Controller review regardless of value

Approvers have 3 working days to act; the system escalates to the next level after 3 days and notifies Finance after 5. Splitting an invoice or PO to stay below a tier is a policy violation. Approvers cannot approve invoices for vendors they requested or have a personal interest in.

5. Payment Runs

Approved invoices are paid in two scheduled payment runs each week: Tuesday and Friday. The cut-off for inclusion is 12:00 SGT on the preceding business day (Monday for Tuesday runs; Thursday for Friday runs). Payments are released through the corporate business account using dual authorisation: one AP preparer and one authorised signatory from Finance. Urgent out-of-cycle payments need Finance Controller approval and are capped at 3 per month per department. Foreign-currency payments use the FX rate quoted on the day of release; AP records the realised FX difference to the FX gain/loss account.

6. Vendor Onboarding Checks

No vendor may be paid until it is set up in the vendor master by AP following the checks below. Vendor master changes, especially bank detail changes, are verified by a call-back to a known contact number.

• Completed Vendor Onboarding Form signed by the requester's Head of Department.

• ACRA business profile or equivalent registration check; GST registration verified on the IRAS GST register where applicable.

• Sanctions and adverse media screening by the Compliance team (result valid 12 months).

• Bank account verification via a SGD 0.01 test transfer or bank letter, with account name matching the legal name.

• Contract or master service agreement reviewed by Legal for spend above SGD 50,000 per year.

• Data protection and security assessment (Security team) for any vendor handling customer personal data under the PDPA.

• Conflict of interest declaration by the requester.

7. Controls and Reporting

AP runs a duplicate payment check on invoice number, vendor and amount before each run. The Finance Controller reviews a weekly exception report covering holds older than 10 days, Non-PO invoices and tier escalations. Target KPIs: 95 percent of invoices paid within terms, fewer than 0.2 percent duplicate payments, and 100 percent of invoices above SGD 50,000 carrying CFO approval evidence. Records are retained for 7 years in line with Singapore requirements.